

MS Word High-Yield — Detailed Lecture Notes

JKSSB Computer Awareness

October 8, 2026

23.1 Why these Word tools are high-yield

MS Word is a large program, but JKSSB does not test it evenly. A small set of review and editing tools is asked again and again, usually as an exact shortcut or as a near-neighbour distinction. This lesson covers that set: Find and Replace, spell check, hyperlinks and bookmarks, styles, comments, Track Changes, Page Break versus Section Break, mail merge, and saving, printing and exporting to PDF. The aim is not to learn every menu; it is to know each tool's shortcut and the one thing it is *not*.

Definition (The high-yield set). *The Word features that competitive-exam items concentrate on: Find/Replace, spell check and grammar tools, hyperlinks and bookmarks, styles, comments, Track Changes, Section Break, mail merge, and PDF export.*

Term	Meaning in this lesson
Find/Replace	The tool to locate text and swap it for other text.
Spell check	Word's proofing tool for spelling and grammar.
Bookmark	A named location or selection inside a document.
Style	A named set of formatting applied to text or a paragraph.
Track Changes	A mode that records every edit with its author.
Section Break	A break that starts a new section with its own layout.
Mail merge	Combining a standard letter with a list of records.
PDF	Portable Document Format — a fixed-layout file.

23.2 Finding and replacing text

Word has two related tools. **Find** locates text in the document and is opened with **Ctrl+F**. **Find and Replace** both locates text and substitutes new text for it, and is opened with **Ctrl+H**. Inside the Find and Replace dialog, *Replace* changes the current match while *Replace All* changes every match in one step. The same dialog can find formatting, special characters (such as a paragraph mark) and text that uses a particular style.

The common confusion is between the two shortcuts. Ctrl+F only finds; it does not change anything. Ctrl+H is the one that replaces. An item that asks how to “find and replace” text expects Ctrl+H.

Example 23.2.1. *A student has typed the word “recieve” in ten places and wants “receive” everywhere. Press Ctrl+H, type **recieve** in the Find box and **receive** in the Replace box, then choose Replace All. Using Ctrl+F alone would only highlight the mistakes one by one, without correcting them.*

23.3 Spelling and grammar tools

Press **F7** to start the **spelling and grammar** check. Word flags a possible misspelling with a red squiggle and a possible grammar problem with another underline. Modern Word gathers these checks in the **Editor** pane, which groups Spelling, Grammar and Refinements. From the check you can *Ignore* a flagged word once, *Ignore All* every occurrence, or *Add* the word to the dictionary so it is accepted from then on.

Two automatic tools support proofing. **AutoCorrect** fixes common typing errors as you type (for example, capitalising the first letter of a sentence), and the **thesaurus** (Shift+F7) offers synonyms. The exam usually tests only the main shortcut, F7. Do not confuse F7 with the PowerPoint slide-show keys: F5 starts a slide show and F9 has other roles in PowerPoint, but in Word F7 is proofing.

Definition (Spell check). *The Word tool, opened with F7, that checks spelling and grammar and offers corrections, ignoring or adding words to the dictionary.*

23.4 Hyperlinks and bookmarks

A **hyperlink** is text or an object that jumps to another place when clicked. Press **Ctrl+K** to insert one. A hyperlink can point to a web address, to a file, or to a location inside the same document. When it points inside the document, it usually points to a **bookmark**.

A **bookmark** gives a location or a selection a name, so that text, a hyperlink or a cross-reference can jump to it. Bookmarks are not printed and are not visible to the reader by default; they are an internal target. The clean distinction for the exam is that a hyperlink is the *clickable link*, while a bookmark is the *named target* it points to.

23.5 Styles

A **style** is a named collection of formatting settings: font, size, colour, spacing, alignment and indent. Instead of formatting each paragraph by hand, you apply a style. Applying a **Heading** style does more than change the look: it gives the paragraph an outline level. That is why the **Navigation Pane** can list the document's headings and why a **Table of Contents** can be built and refreshed automatically.

Style-based formatting is consistent and easy to update. If you edit a style, every paragraph that uses that style changes at once. This is the main advantage of styles over direct formatting.

Example 23.5.1. *A report uses the Heading 1 style for its chapter titles. Later the author wants all chapter titles in a larger font. Instead of selecting every title, the author edits the Heading 1 style once, and every chapter title updates automatically. The Navigation Pane and the table of contents also stay correct.*

23.6 Comments and Track Changes

A **comment** is a note attached to a point in the document. It lets a reviewer ask a question or suggest a change *without editing the text itself*. Comments can be replied to and marked resolved, and they are stored as metadata shown in the margin or the Reviewing Pane.

Track Changes is different: it records the actual edits. When it is on, each insertion, deletion and formatting change is marked, together with the **author's name** and the time. This is called

revision metadata. The reviewer then **Accepts** or **Rejects** each change individually or all at once. Accepting a change keeps it permanently and, with it, removes the revision metadata for that change. Rejecting a change removes the edit and keeps the original text.

Definition (Track Changes). *A Word mode that records every insertion, deletion and formatting edit along with the author and time, so a reviewer can accept or reject each change.*

23.7 Page Break versus Section Break

A **Page Break** pushes the following text onto a new page. It does not start a new section, so the page keeps the same layout, margins, headers, footers and page numbering as the rest of the document. A quick way to insert a page break is **Ctrl+Enter**.

A **Section Break** divides the document into independent **sections**. Because each section has its own layout settings, a Section Break is what allows *different headers and footers*, different page numbering, different margins or a different page orientation within one document. Section Breaks are inserted from the **Layout** tab, under **Breaks**.

This is one of the most tested Word traps. A Page Break changes only the page; a Section Break changes the section. Only a Section Break can give a document two different headers or footers. (TRAP-13)

Example 23.7.1. *An item states, “Using Page Break allows you to have different headers and footers in the same document.” This is wrong. A Page Break keeps the same section formatting. It is a **Section Break** that allows different headers and footers in one document. (PYQ-13)*

23.8 Mail merge

Mail merge is the process that combines a **main document** (a standard letter or template) with a **data source** (a list of records such as names and addresses). The main document contains **merge fields** as placeholders, and each record fills those fields to produce one personalised copy. A common data source is a table of names and addresses held in Excel or in Outlook contacts.

The typical steps are: create or select the main document; select recipients (the data source); insert merge fields; preview the results; and finish the merge by printing the letters or sending them by email. The exam definition to remember is that mail merge *combines letters with a database of addresses*. (PYQ-37, PYQ-47)

Definition (Mail merge). *The Word process that combines a standard document with a data source of records, producing one personalised copy of the document for each record.*

23.9 Saving, printing and exporting to PDF

Press **Ctrl+S** to save the document; Word normally saves it in the **DOCX** format. Press **Ctrl+P** to open the print options. **Save As** can change the file name, the location and the file format. Using **Export** or **Save As PDF** creates a **PDF** file.

PDF stands for **Portable Document Format**. A PDF is a *fixed-layout* file: it looks the same on every device and is good for sharing and printing, but it is not meant for easy editing. This pairs with the separate lesson on file formats, where the extension (for example, **.pdf**) and the format (PDF) are kept distinct.

23.10 Exam retrieval and common confusions

Five distinctions prevent most errors on this topic.

1. **Ctrl+F** finds; **Ctrl+H** finds and replaces. Do not swap them.
2. **F7** is spelling and grammar in Word; F5 starts a PowerPoint slide show. (TRAP-32)
3. A **Section Break**, not a Page Break, enables different headers/footers in one document. (TRAP-13)
4. A **bookmark** is a named target; a **hyperlink** (**Ctrl+K**) is the clickable link.
5. **Mail Merge** combines a letter with an address database; it is not Track Changes or Auto-Correct. (TRAP-29)

Example 23.10.1. *An item asks which feature combines letters with a database of addresses. Trace the meaning: a standard letter plus a list of records is mail merge. If the item instead asks what records every edit with its author, the answer is Track Changes, and if it asks what fixes typing errors as you type, the answer is AutoCorrect. (PYQ-37, PYQ-47)*

Exercises

1. State the shortcuts for Find, Find and Replace, spelling and grammar, and inserting a hyperlink.
2. Explain the difference between a Page Break and a Section Break, and say which one allows different headers and footers.
3. Distinguish a bookmark from a hyperlink.
4. What does Track Changes record, and what happens when a change is accepted?
5. Define mail merge and name its two parts.

Solutions

1. Find: Ctrl+F. Find and Replace: Ctrl+H. Spelling and grammar: F7. Insert a hyperlink: Ctrl+K.
2. A Page Break moves text to a new page within the same section. A Section Break starts a new section with its own layout. Only a Section Break allows different headers and footers.
3. A bookmark is a named location or selection inside the document; it is a target and is not printed. A hyperlink is clickable text or an object that jumps to a target, which may be a bookmark, a file or a web address.
4. Track Changes records every insertion, deletion and formatting edit, together with the author's name and the time (revision metadata). Accepting a change keeps it permanently and removes that change's revision metadata.
5. Mail merge combines a main document (the standard letter or template) with a data source (a list of records such as names and addresses) to produce one personalised copy per record.